



K1 at The City School
parent coffee morning
August 2026

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We believe:

The formative years of childhood shape a life. We cherish them.

We envision:

A school that redefines what education can be when it is built around the child: where every child is known, understood, and valued. Where childhood is given the time and space to flourish. Where the foundations built give children the confidence to explore, to take risks, and to build lives of meaning and consequence.

We promise:

To honour each child as a born researcher, and to know who they are and how they learn.

To educate with academic rigour, and to deepen that knowledge inside Projects of research, where learning is built around your child's own questions.

To design spaces of beauty and intention where wonderings turn into discoveries.

To grow curiosity, confidence in their own voice, kindness in working with others, and the love of learning that a life is built on.

To welcome you inside that learning as our partner.

igniting each child's full potential

Striving for excellence through deliberate practice in the academic
languages of mathematics and literacy

Acting for the good of self and others,
doing the right thing for the right reasons, with
kindness and taking action

Innovative thinking and expression to
share ideas and solutions. Acting holistically to
think. Logical yet agile



the ability to analyze, evaluate, and
synthesize, using research skills, thinking
skills and evidence-based dialogue

Addressing the strengths of our
community and culture through
work, a connected home/school
environment, positive relationships and
valuing diversity

Effective and ethical verbal and non-verbal communication
skills, active listening, positive interactions

a family of schools



PURPLE ELEPHANT



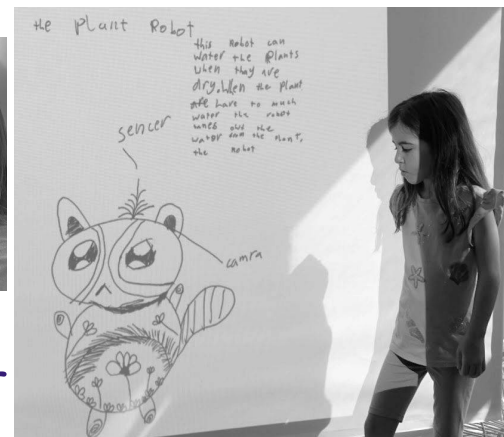
K1&2



Y4+



Y1&2



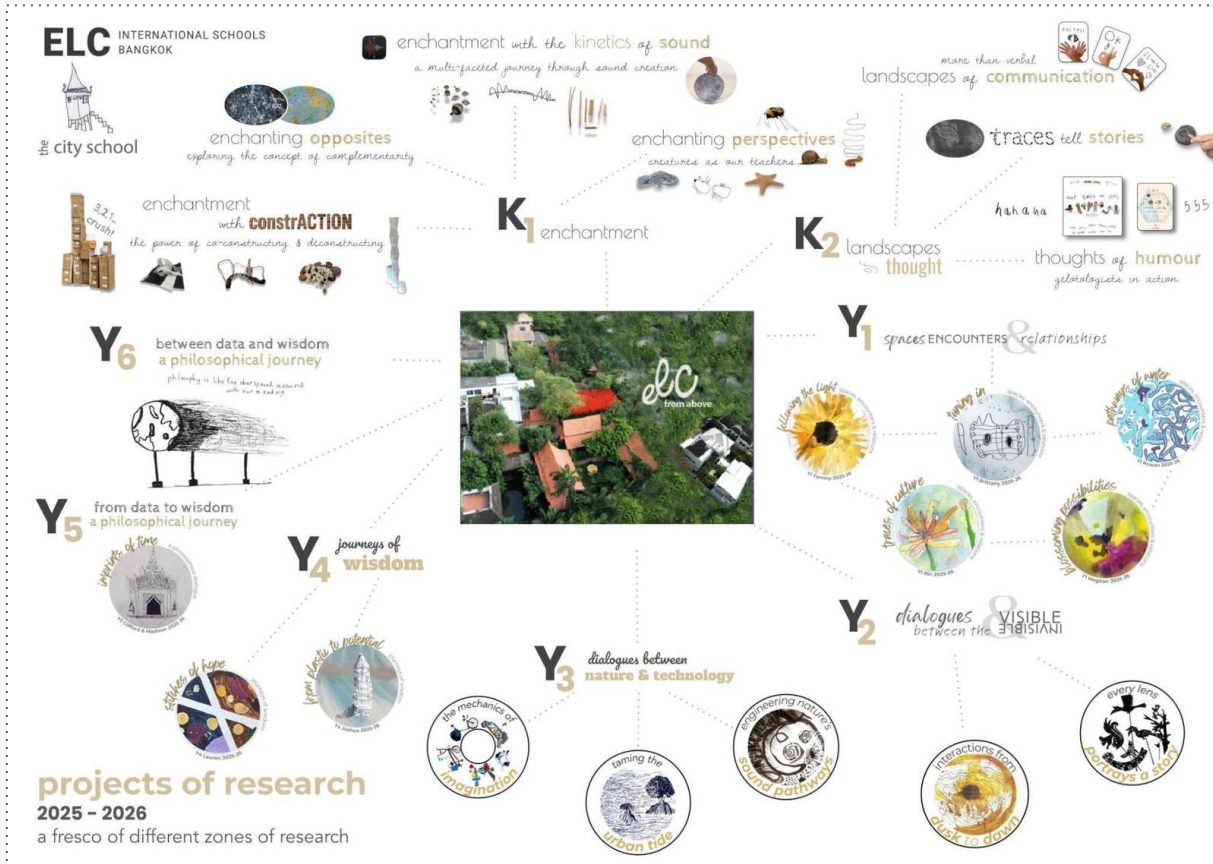
the City School

the learning environment at the City School provides:

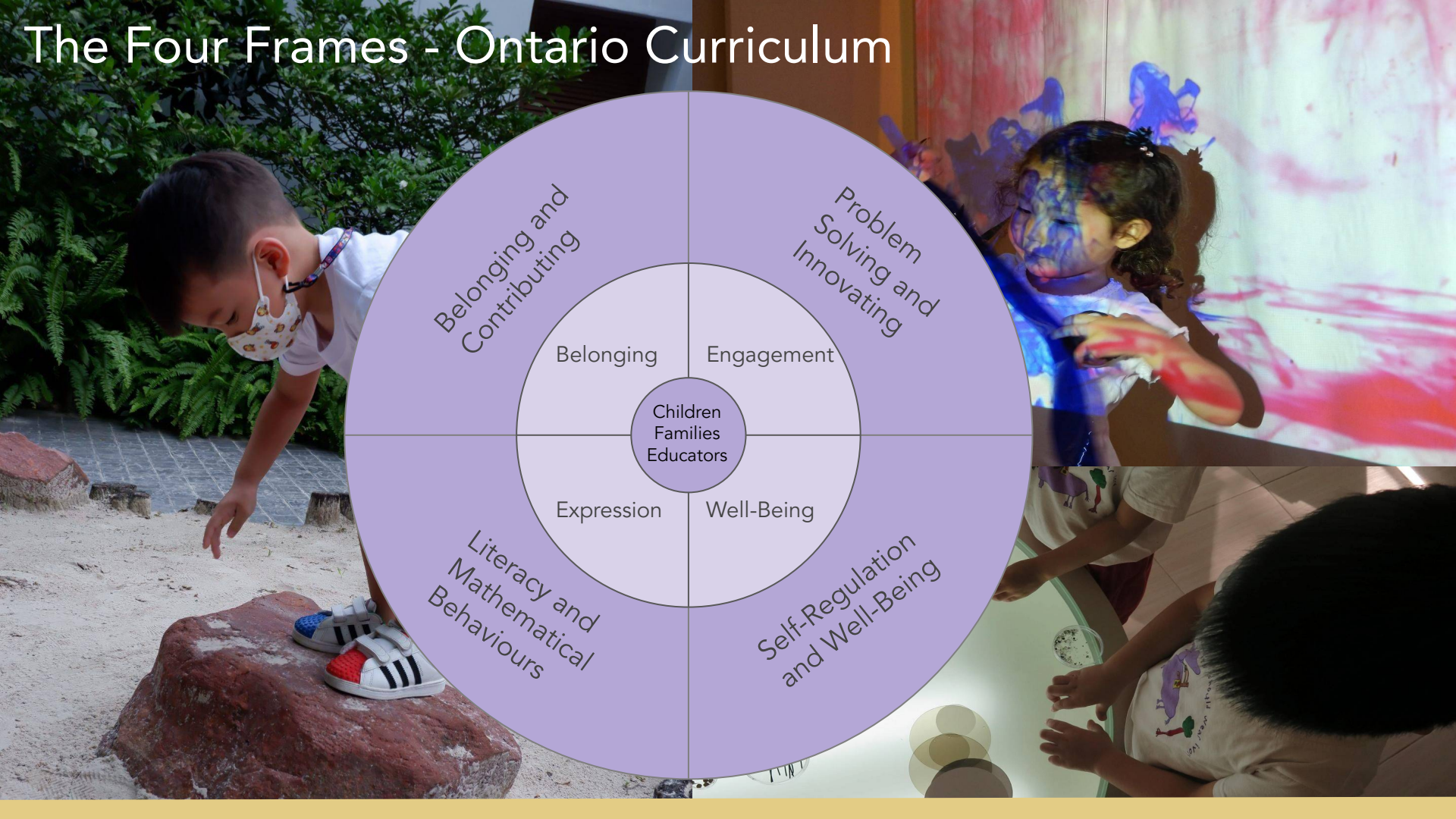
- an opportunity to grow literacy and numeracy skills
- an opportunity to develop empathy and a connection to nature
- a place to ask questions and seek answers to those questions
- the opportunity to combine rational and imaginative thought
- room for art and science to exist together in harmony
- an intimate setting for developing relationships



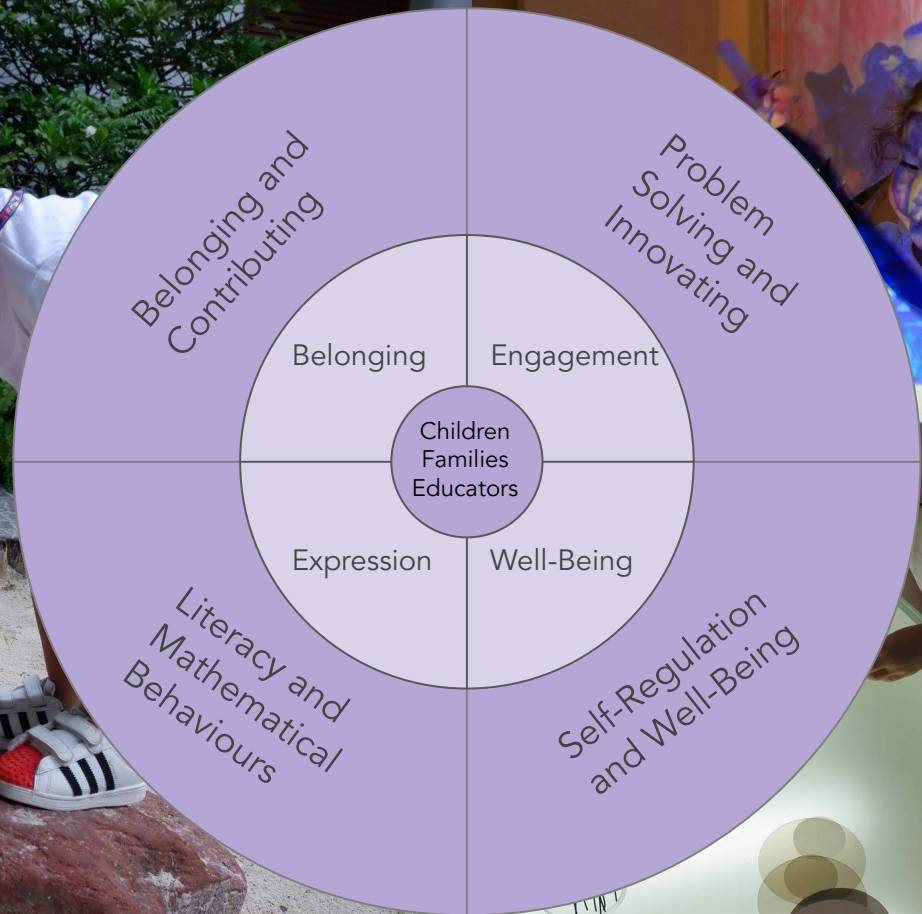
a Project based approach



- allows for contextual learning based on modern research and the **interests of the children**
- development of reflection skills and **metacognition**
- high level thinking skills that are fundamental across disciplines
- development of **critical thinkers** who can be flexible in the application of knowledge
- fosters the natural curiosity of children through asking questions, making observations, developing hypotheses, and forming **theories**



The Four Frames - Ontario Curriculum



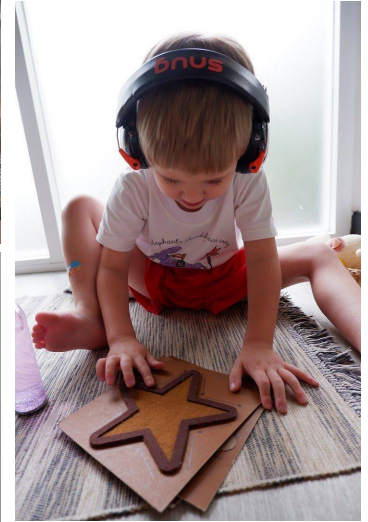
belonging and contributing



- Developing self-confidence and empathy
- Encouraging children to see themselves as competent members of a bigger community
- Recognizing the unique skills and contributions of others
- Building of confidence to share ideas in a number of expressive languages
- First six weeks is spent developing trust and belonging to the classroom community

self-regulation and well-being

- Establishing confidence and independence
- Social emotional development in terms of relationships with self, others, the community, and the environment
- Self-care and physical health
- Developing prosocial behaviour that allows for collaboration, sharing of materials, and strong sense of identity
- Learn natural physical limits through supported risk taking
- Understanding the wide spectrum of human emotion and developing strategies for dealing with them



developmental milestones and education

Kindergarten 1 (3-4 years)

Physical Development

- Improved coordination and balance, leading to more controlled movements
- Demonstrating increased control over fine motor skills like drawing simple shapes, coloring within lines starting to use scissors
- Dressing and undressing with minimal assistance
- Fully potty trained

Social and Emotional Development

- Continue to assert their independence and may still have occasional tantrums
- Start to show consistently in empathy and concern for others' feelings
- Begin playing cooperatively with other children, although parallel play will still be common
- Have a sense of security with familiar adults
- Start developing a sense of identity and self-esteem

How do we support your child's development?

specialist classes *mark making*
expressive languages
communication centre *supervised risk taking*
celebrating independence

social stories and roleplay *consistent routines*
project and collaboration
self-expression *encouraged independence*
Responsive Classroom

demonstrating literacy and mathematical behaviours



Mathematics

- Introduction to principles of number
- Intentional instruction with play based reinforcement of concepts
- Authentic contexts for learning through Project and other observations
- Spiral approach to curriculum standards allow for review and revision across a year

Literacy

- Mark Making and letter elements through Penpals
- Reading as a reader, reading as a writer
- Introduction to writing through bookmaking
- Formal reading programme begins in K2
- Speaking and communication
- Expressive languages

problem solving and innovating

- Project based approach to learning
- Encouraging children to develop skills that transcend disciplines such as critical and creative thinking, and problem solving
- Emphasis on expressive languages as a mode of thinking and learning
- Play as the primary tool for exploration and developing understanding
- Authentic and contextual contexts for discovery



developmental milestones and education

Kindergarten 1 (3-4 years)

Cognitive Development

- Developing a longer attention span, often able to focus on a task for 10-15 minutes
- Beginning to understand and use basic concepts like size (big/little) and numbers (counting to 5 or more)
- Enjoying puzzles and games
- Developing an understanding of cause and effect
- Showing an interest in books and storytelling, often retelling familiar stories

How do we support your child's development?

play-based learning *project*
authentic reading opportunities
hands-on experiences *theory development*
mathematizing the world

Language Development

- Rapidly expanding vocabulary, using 900-1,000 words or more
- Sentences will become longer and more complex
- Asking a lot of "why" and "how" questions
- Engaging in more elaborate storytelling and imaginative play
- Showing an interest in rhyming words and recognizing some letters

questioning *vocabulary expansion*
oral language skills
writing development *reading comprehension*

the role of the parent



on the first day of school:

- arrive early and spend a few minutes together exploring the campus
- be honest with your child
- accept that it is emotional and remind your child they are safe at school and that you will come back
- say goodbye quickly and calmly - your demeanour and energy level will be mirrored by your child

ongoing support

- engage in positive reciprocal relationships with educators, administrators and other families at The City School
- attend workshops and school events to stay up to date with what is happening on campus
- talk to your child about their day regularly using specific questions
- play with and read to your child often at at home; play is the work of children



morning drop-off can be hard...

A tearful goodbye during the first days of school is common. We want to empower children to manage and regulate their emotions in safe, comforting environments.

Our instincts, and often our upbringings, make us think that if children aren't crying they will be ok. We hear caregivers say:

"You're ok, don't cry. Everything is going to be ok, you'll have fun and see your friends."

This doesn't acknowledge and allow for the big feelings that we can all have. Instead we can try...

You might cry and miss me when we say goodbye. That's ok, I will miss you too. It's because we love each other. We will see each other at the end of the day.

At home, I take care of you and at school your teachers will take care of you. If you feel sad or have a question, you can talk to your teachers and they will help you.

You were scared and cried when we went to school last year too. But remember how much you loved it when you got used to it?

It's ok to cry. When you're finished crying, what do you think you will want to do? You can try playing with....

There are lots of new things this year, and new things can be scary. But they're only scary until we get used to them. Your classroom is different, but you'll find lots of the same toys. Some of the children will be different, but you'll still get to play together on the swings.

safe and secure community

Emergency Operations Policy and Plan

- Fire
- Lightning
- Earthquake
- Flooding
- Lockdown
- Infectious diseases

At the City School, we maintain low teacher-child ratios so that we can continue to provide a high level of care to your children and get to know each child individually.

Safeguarding and Protection

- air quality - AQI
- nut-free school
- full time nurse on campus
- Data Protection Policies
 - E-Safety: phones, emails, videos
- guards, duties, lanyards
- designated adult toilets for parents/visitors
- duty of care
- Child Protection Policies

things to prepare in the first days



To Purchase:

- PE uniform*
- ballet shoes

*Please visit Praveen's office to purchase PE uniform.



To Bring:

- A set of spare clothes each day
- On Water Exploration days, please bring two sets of spare clothes
- Easy slip-on shoes



Labeling:

Please label your child's lunchbox, water bottle, and any lunch deliveries with their name and class. For example: CHILD'S NAME +K1 Katie



Lunch delivery:

Please have your child's lunch delivered by **11:30 AM**.
All food deliveries should be labeled clearly with your child's name and class. For example: CHILD'S NAME + K1 Katie
Important: **Please ensure all meals are nut-free.**

extended hours

- Led by our teachers, in our classrooms
- 3, 4, and 5 days per week options available in English or Mandarin
- Join at any time throughout the year - we are ready when your child is!
- Extends the school day from 1pm to 2:30pm
- Enrollment is on the Parent Portal

	Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday
English	Thai Dance	PE	Thai Culture	Mandarin	Music
Mandarin	PE	Thai Dance	Mandarin	Music	Thai Culture

notable events - before Christmas



first day of school

Loy Krathong

parent workshops

open evening

holiday pageant

Father's Day

progress meetings

report cards & conferences

end of term party

notable events - after Christmas



Carnival of Cultures

Songkran

Project Learning Journeys

Art from the Heart

year end performances

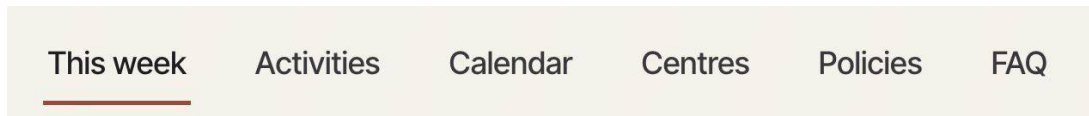
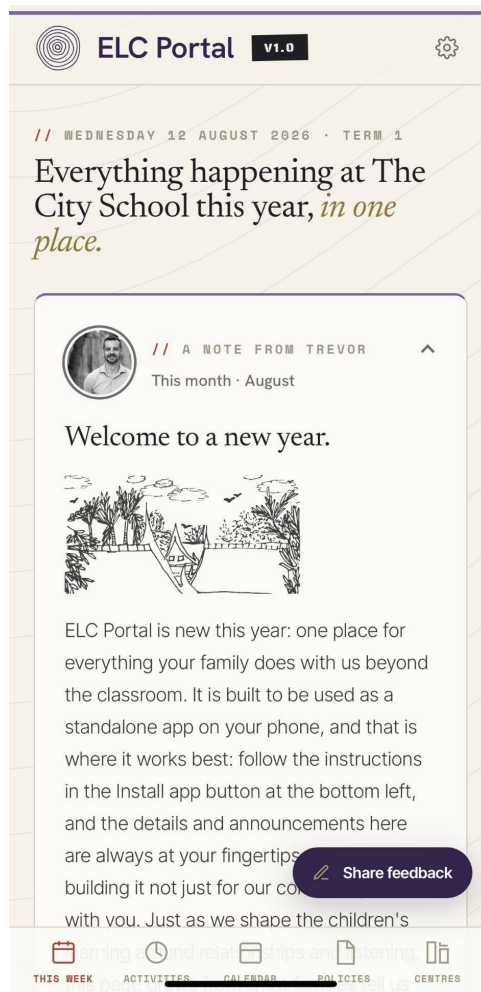
progress meetings

report cards & conferences

Festival of Children's Literature

whole school communication

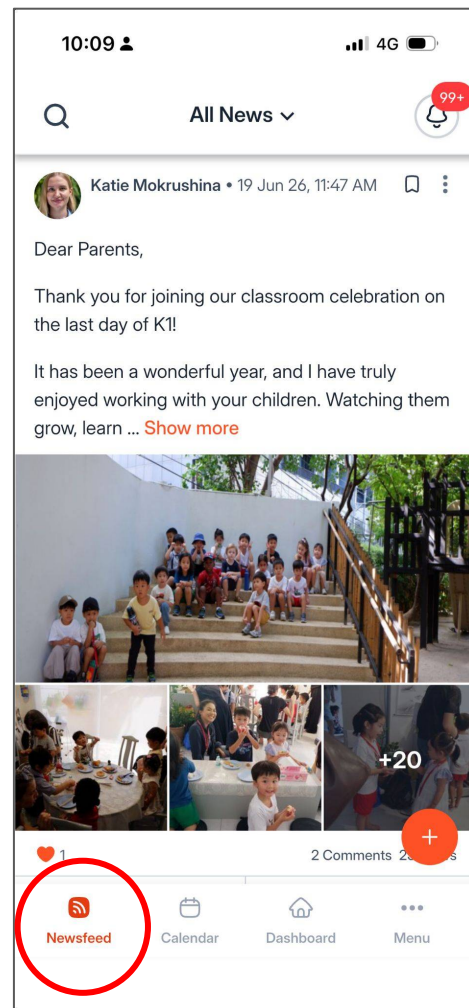
Custom built - for us, by us! ELC Portal will be your go to source for information about everything happening across all our ELC campus. Find policies, parent handbooks, signups, event registration and more!



Parent

We want you to see what's happening in our classrooms! Teachers across the school will regularly update Parent App with posts about the amazing learning your children do every day. Photos are available for you to download and keep as memories of ELC for years to come.

We recommend that you tag your child in posts on a regular basis. When a child changes year level, all the previous year's posts will disappear.



parent partnerships

At The City School, we partner with parents to ensure their child is developing competencies both academically and socially and emotionally.

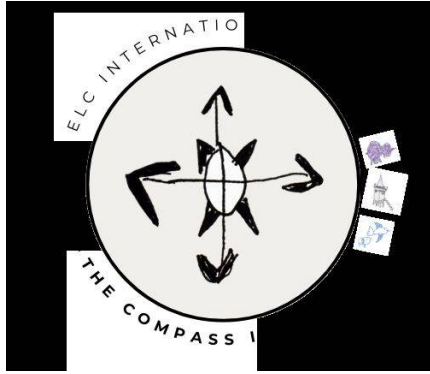
We understand that it is important to know children, understand them, and support their growth and development not only in their current year levels, but beyond.

We prepare your children, throughout their time at The City School, to be ready for transitions to other schools and systems beyond Year 6. We view this as being partners in a child's learning journey for life.



the compass initiative

supporting your learning journey from birth through to adulthood



Developed in 2024-2025, the goal of The Compass Initiative is to provide families with personalized one to one guidance on future schools, both locally and internationally, for children within our community.

The Compass Initiative addresses our community promise of parents as partners and helps reinforce all four quadrants by sharing with parents not only advice on future schooling, but how we best prepare all children for the inevitable transition.



Pippa: ELC has helped me prepare for middle school with good teamwork skills, leadership skills, and the growth mindset that has helped me throughout the year such as helping me become a student leader in my year at NIST.

a bright future



At middle and high school level we recommend these schools for their excellent academic standing and pathways to international universities and a diverse student body (English is the language of the classroom, the halls and playground)

Our students predominantly enter these institutions as we prepare them academically, socially, and emotionally.

City School children thrive when they enter these schools. Possessed with a love for learning, the voice and confidence to handle a complex setting and excellent academics and 21st century skills.

getting in touch



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